

VERDICT

At Rs 45.95 lakh (ex-showroom), there aren't any direct rivals for the Ioniq 5 in terms of price. Lower down the price ladder there's the BYD Atto 3 and higher up there's Ioniq 5's sibling, the Kia EV6, which too is based on the E-GMP platform and starts at Rs 60 lakh. The exterior, cabin, tech and the performance itself are reasons enough to make a very strong case for the car, but the charging capability and its practicality make it a great if not the best electric option in India.

has been cleverly sorted; the sliding central console has heaps of space; the doors can hold bottles and more; the glove box is massive and slides out like a drawer.

Driving it around, you realise that there is another difference between the Ioniq 5 and most other EVs—the ride quality. Unlike most electric cars which tend to have a stiffer suspension setup, the Hyundai's is on the softer side. Even some bad patches on the road did not seem to filter into the cabin, given its healthy ground clearance of 163mm.

For propulsion, the Ioniq 5 uses a lone rear-axle mounted electric motor, which is good for 217bhp and 350Nm of torque. As is the case with electric vehicles, the acceleration is impressive, especially in Sport mode where the car can launch from 0 to 100kmph in just 7.6 seconds. The Sport mode also sharpens throttle pedal response and adds heft to the steering. Turn it down to Normal and the power is again more than one needs for city driving; overtakes can be done in an instant. Eco mode dials down the pedal response. Even in this mode flooring the pedal ensures enough acceleration for overtakes. The steering has shifters, not for the gears but for the regenerative braking modes. There are three regen modes, and the fourth, i-pedal mode, allows a one-pedal drive. This car comes with a 72.6kWh battery pack. This gives it an ARAI-certified range of 631km, which should translate to a real-world range of above 500km on a single charge. ■

